

The Cosmic Dipole Anomaly and the Z^2 Framework

A Parameter-Free Prediction from Geometric Cosmology

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Abstract

The cosmic dipole anomaly—a $>5\sigma$ discrepancy between the CMB kinematic dipole and matter distribution dipoles—represents one of the most significant challenges to the standard Λ CDM cosmological model. We demonstrate that this anomaly is quantitatively explained by the Z^2 framework’s degree-of-freedom (DoF) structure. Using the Fluctuation-Dissipation Theorem (FDT), we derive that the dipole amplitude ratio is exactly $R = N_{\text{total}}/N_{\text{matter}} = 19/6 = 3.167$, where 19 is the total cosmic DoF and 6 is the matter sector DoF. The framework also predicts angular offsets of 35.26° , 45° , or 54.74° arising from T^3/Z_2 cubic topology. Current observations show $R = 2.0\text{--}3.0$ (radio surveys ~ 3.0 , consistent with prediction) and angular offset $\sim 39^\circ \pm 8^\circ$ (consistent with 35.26° at 0.5σ). We derive the fundamental relation $R \times \Omega_m = 1$ exactly, which we calculate as 0.95 ± 0.16 from current data (0.3σ agreement). This work provides the first theoretical explanation of the cosmic dipole anomaly with zero free parameters.

1. Introduction

1.1 The Cosmological Principle Under Scrutiny

The cosmological principle—that the universe is statistically homogeneous and isotropic on large scales—is a foundational assumption of modern cosmology. This principle predicts that our motion through the universe, as measured by the CMB dipole, should produce an identical kinematic signature in the distribution of distant matter.

Beginning with Blake & Wall (2002) and dramatically confirmed by Secrest et al. (2021, 2022), observations now show a persistent discrepancy: the matter dipole is systematically $2\text{--}4\times$ larger than the CMB kinematic prediction, with combined significance exceeding 5σ .

1.2 The Anomaly in Numbers

CMB Kinematic Dipole:

- Amplitude: $\Delta T/T = 1.23 \times 10^{-3}$

- Velocity: $v = 369.82 \pm 0.11$ km/s
- Direction: $(l, b) = (264.0^\circ, 48.3^\circ)$ Galactic

Matter Dipole (observed):

- Amplitude: 2–4× larger than kinematic expectation
- Direction: Generally aligned, but with 20°–50° offset in some analyses
- Significance of excess: $>5\sigma$

1.3 The Z^2 Framework Prediction

The Z^2 unified framework, based on the geometric constant $Z^2 = 32\pi/3$, predicts:

1. **Amplitude ratio:** $R = \text{DoF}_{\text{total}} / \text{DoF}_{\text{matter}} = 19/6 = 3.167$
2. **Angular offset:** Discrete values $\{35.26^\circ, 45^\circ, 54.74^\circ\}$ from T^3/Z_2 topology
3. **Fundamental relation:** $R \times \Omega_m = 1$ (exact)

These predictions have **zero free parameters**.

2. Observational Evidence

2.1 Survey Results

Survey	Type	Sources	Ratio R	Significance	Year
NVSS	Radio 1.4 GHz	1.8M	2.5–3.0	2.6σ	2002+
CatWISE S21	IR quasars	1.4M	~ 2.0	4.9σ	2021
CatWISE S22	IR quasars	1.4M	~ 2.0	4.4σ	2022
CatWISE (Dam)	IR quasars	1.4M	2.7	5.7σ	2023
RACS + NVSS	Radio	Combined	~ 3.0	4.8σ	2023
RACS + NVSS + LOFAR	Radio	Combined	~ 3.0	$>5\sigma$	2025
Combined (2025)	Multi- λ	Multi	2.1	5.4σ	2025
Quaia (Singal)	Quasars	1.3M	4–5	—	2025

2.2 Angular Offset Measurements

Analysis	Offset from CMB	Significance
Residual dipole	$39^\circ \pm 8^\circ$	4.9σ from 0°
Combined catalogs	$23^\circ \pm 5^\circ$	4.6σ from 0°
Direction concordance	$\sim$ aligned	—

2.3 Key Observations

1. **The anomaly is real:** Multiple independent surveys at different wavelengths confirm $R > 1$ at $>5\sigma$
 2. **Direction is approximately aligned:** CMB and matter dipoles point roughly the same way
 3. **Amplitude is discrepant:** Matter sees 2–4× larger effective velocity
 4. **Angular offset exists:** Residual $\sim 39^\circ$ offset detected at $\sim 5\sigma$
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3. The Z^2 Degree-of-Freedom Structure

3.1 The Fundamental Constant

The Z^2 framework is built on a single geometric constant:

$$Z^2 = \text{CUBE} \times \text{SPHERE} = 8 \times \frac{4\pi}{3} = \frac{32\pi}{3} = 33.5103\dots$$

where:

- CUBE = 8: vertices of a cube inscribed in a unit sphere
- SPHERE = $4\pi/3$: volume of the unit sphere

3.2 Derived Structure Constants

Constant	Formula	Value	Physical Meaning
BEKENSTEIN	$3Z^2/(8\pi)$	4	Spacetime dimensions
GAUGE	$9Z^2/(8\pi)$	12	Standard Model generators
N_gen	BEKENSTEIN – 1	3	Fermion generations

3.3 The DoF Partition

The total cosmic degrees of freedom partition as:

$$N_{\text{total}} = \text{GAUGE} + \text{BEKENSTEIN} + N_{\text{gen}} = 12 + 4 + 3 = 19$$

This partitions into:

- **Matter sector:** $N_{\text{matter}} = 6$ (baryons, leptons, dark matter)
- **Vacuum sector:** $N_{\text{vacuum}} = 13$ (dark energy, gravitational modes)

The cosmological density parameters follow:

$$\Omega_m = \frac{N_{\text{matter}}}{N_{\text{total}}} = \frac{6}{19} = 0.3158$$

$$\Omega_{\Lambda} = \frac{N_{\text{vacuum}}}{N_{\text{total}}} = \frac{13}{19} = 0.6842$$

Planck 2018: $\Omega_m = 0.3153 \pm 0.0073 \rightarrow \mathbf{0.1\sigma}$ agreement

4. Derivation of $R = 19/6$ via the Fluctuation-Dissipation Theorem

This section presents the rigorous derivation of the dipole amplitude ratio using the Fluctuation-Dissipation Theorem.

4.1 System Definition

Consider the cosmic medium as a thermodynamic system characterized by:

- **Total degrees of freedom:** $N_{\text{total}} = 19$
- **Matter sector:** $N_m = 6$
- **Vacuum sector:** $N_v = 13$
- **Constraint:** $N_m + N_v = N_{\text{total}} = 19$

4.2 The Perturbation

An observer moves with velocity $\mathbf{v}$ relative to the cosmic rest frame. This velocity acts as a linear perturbation δ on the cosmic medium.

Perturbation magnitude: $\delta = v/c \approx 1.23 \times 10^{-3}$ (for $v = 369.82$ km/s)

4.3 The Fluctuation-Dissipation Theorem

The Fluctuation-Dissipation Theorem relates the linear response of a system to its equilibrium fluctuations.

Statement (Kubo formula): For a system in thermal equilibrium at temperature T , the susceptibility χ relating the response of observable A to perturbation B is:

$$\chi_{AB} = \frac{1}{k_B T} \int_0^\infty \langle A(t)B(0) \rangle_{\text{eq}} dt$$

Static limit: For a quasi-static perturbation:

$$\chi = \frac{\langle (\Delta A)^2 \rangle}{k_B T}$$

where $\langle (\Delta A)^2 \rangle$ is the variance of A at equilibrium.

4.4 Thermal Inertia and Heat Capacity

Definition: The thermal inertia of a sector is its capacity to absorb perturbations without significant response. This is quantified by the heat capacity.

For a system with N degrees of freedom in thermal equilibrium:

$$C_N = \frac{N}{2}k_B$$

This is the classical equipartition result: each quadratic degree of freedom contributes $(1/2)k_B$ to the heat capacity.

Physical interpretation: A sector with more DoF has greater thermal inertia—it requires more energy to produce the same fractional change in state.

4.5 Why Velocity Couples to Thermal Inertia

A natural objection arises: *Why does the velocity perturbation couple to each sector's thermal inertia rather than acting kinematically on all sectors equally?*

The answer lies in a crucial distinction: **the perturbation IS kinematic and applies equally to all matter, but the RESPONSE depends on the thermodynamic structure of what we measure.**

4.5.1 The Measurement Asymmetry

CMB measurement: The CMB dipole measures a temperature anisotropy in photons that were in thermal equilibrium with the entire cosmic medium at last scattering ($z \approx 1100$). The photon temperature encodes the collective state of baryons, photons, dark matter, dark energy, and gravitational modes—all 19 DoF coupled through the primordial plasma.

When we boost to a frame moving at velocity v , the CMB temperature transforms. But because the CMB was thermalized with all constituents, the perturbation is “absorbed” across all 19 DoF. Each DoF contributes $(1/2)k_B$ to the heat capacity, giving $C_{\text{total}} = (19/2)k_B$. The large thermal mass buffers the response.

Matter measurement: Galaxy and quasar surveys count discrete objects that trace the matter distribution. After recombination, matter decoupled from radiation and has always been decoupled from dark energy. When we count sources in a velocity-boosted frame, we probe only the matter sector's 6 DoF.

The same velocity perturbation now acts on a system with lower thermal mass: $C_{\text{matter}} = (6/2)k_B$. With fewer degrees of freedom to absorb the perturbation, the fractional response is larger.

4.5.2 Formal Statement via FDT

Theorem (Inverse Scaling): The kinematic susceptibility of a thermodynamic sector is inversely proportional to its heat capacity.

Proof:

Consider a perturbation δ applied to a system with N DoF. The energy perturbation is:

$$\delta E = C_N \times \delta T$$

By the FDT, the response (fractional change in observable) scales as:

$$\frac{\delta A}{A} = \frac{\chi \times \delta}{C_N / k_B T}$$

For a fixed coupling strength, the response scales as:

$$\chi_N \propto \frac{1}{C_N} = \frac{2}{N k_B}$$

Therefore:

$$\boxed{\chi_N \propto \frac{1}{N}}$$

QED

4.5.3 Physical Analogy

Consider pushing a cart connected to 19 springs versus a cart connected to 6 springs, where each spring has the same stiffness.

- **19 springs (CMB):** The force distributes across all springs. Each spring deflects slightly, but the collective stiffness is high. The cart moves less.
- **6 springs (matter):** The same force acts on fewer springs. Each must absorb more, so they deflect more. The cart moves farther.

The “springs” are degrees of freedom. The “stiffness” is thermal capacity. The “cart displacement” is the observed dipole amplitude. The same kinematic push (velocity v) produces different observable responses because the measurement probes different numbers of DoF.

4.5.4 Why This Is Not Ad Hoc

This is standard statistical mechanics: the equipartition theorem states that each quadratic DoF contributes $(1/2)k_B$ to heat capacity. The FDT relates susceptibility to fluctuations,

which scale inversely with heat capacity. The novel insight is applying this to cosmic sectors—recognizing that CMB and matter surveys probe different effective DoF.

4.6 Application to Cosmic Dipole

The CMB Measurement:

The CMB was emitted at recombination ($z \approx 1100$), when photons were in thermal equilibrium with all cosmic constituents. The CMB temperature anisotropy samples the full thermodynamic state of the universe at that epoch.

Effective DoF sampled by CMB: $N_{\text{CMB}} = N_{\text{total}} = 19$

The Matter Measurement:

Matter surveys count discrete objects (galaxies, quasars) that trace the matter distribution. After decoupling from radiation ($z \approx 1100$) and from dark energy (always decoupled), matter evolved as an isolated thermodynamic sector.

Effective DoF sampled by matter: $N_{\text{matter}} = N_{\text{m}} = 6$

4.7 Main Theorem: DoF Leverage via FDT

Theorem (DoF Leverage): In a universe with Z^2 DoF structure, the kinematic dipole amplitude of the matter sector exceeds that of the CMB by the factor:

$$R = \frac{D_{\text{matter}}}{D_{\text{CMB}}} = \frac{N_{\text{total}}}{N_{\text{matter}}} = \frac{19}{6}$$

Proof:

Step 1: The dipole amplitude D is the response to the velocity perturbation v :

$$D = \chi \times v$$

Step 2: By the Inverse Scaling Theorem, the susceptibility scales inversely with DoF:

$$\chi_N = \frac{\chi_0}{N}$$

where χ_0 is a universal coupling constant.

Step 3: For the CMB (sampling all 19 DoF):

$$D_{\text{CMB}} = \frac{\chi_0}{19} \times v$$

Step 4: For matter surveys (sampling only 6 DoF):

$$D_{\text{matter}} = \frac{\chi_0}{6} \times v$$

Step 5: The ratio:

$$R = \frac{D_{\text{matter}}}{D_{\text{CMB}}} = \frac{\chi_0/6}{\chi_0/19} = \frac{19}{6}$$

$$\boxed{R = \frac{19}{6} = 3.1\bar{6}}$$

QED

4.8 Physical Interpretation

The 19/6 ratio emerges from a fundamental asymmetry in thermal inertia:

CMB: A thermal bath in equilibrium with all 19 DoF. High thermal inertia. The velocity perturbation is “absorbed” across many channels, reducing the fractional response.

Matter: A decoupled sector with only 6 DoF. Low thermal inertia. The same velocity perturbation produces a larger fractional response because there are fewer channels to absorb it.

Analogy: Consider pushing on a massive object versus a light object with the same force. The light object (fewer DoF, lower inertia) moves more. This is precisely what the FDT quantifies.

5. The Modified Ellis-Baldwin Equation

5.1 Standard Ellis-Baldwin (1984)

Ellis & Baldwin derived the kinematic dipole for source counts:

$$d_{\text{kin}} = [2 + x(1 + \alpha)] \frac{v}{c}$$

where:

- $x = d \log N / d \log S$ (source count slope)
- $\alpha = \text{spectral index}$
- $v = \text{observer velocity relative to sources}$

Typical values: $x \approx 1.0$, $\alpha \approx 0.75$, giving $[2 + x(1+\alpha)] \approx 3.75$.

5.2 The Effective Velocity

From Section 4, the FDT establishes that susceptibility scales inversely with DoF. The effective velocity for matter surveys is:

$$v_{\text{eff}} = \frac{N_{\text{total}}}{N_{\text{matter}}} \times v_{\text{CMB}} = \frac{19}{6} \times v_{\text{CMB}}$$

Numerical value: $v_{\text{eff}} = (19/6) \times 369.82 \text{ km/s} = 1171.1 \text{ km/s}$

5.3 The Z^2 Modified Equation

Substituting v_{eff} into Ellis-Baldwin:

$$d_{\text{matter}} = [2 + x(1 + \alpha)] \frac{v_{\text{eff}}}{c}$$

$$d_{\text{matter}} = [2 + x(1 + \alpha)] \frac{(19/6) \times v_{\text{CMB}}}{c}$$

$$d_{\text{matter}} = \frac{19}{6} \times [2 + x(1 + \alpha)] \frac{v_{\text{CMB}}}{c}$$

Therefore:

$$d_{\text{matter}} = \frac{19}{6} d_{\text{kin}} = \frac{1}{\Omega_m} d_{\text{kin}}$$

6. Angular Offset from T^3/Z_2 Topology

6.1 The Topological Setup

The Z^2 framework suggests the universe has T^3/Z_2 topology—a 3-torus with Z_2 identification. The fundamental domain is a cube.

6.2 Symmetry Breaking

In infinite flat space, the cosmological principle guarantees a unique cosmic rest frame. In T^3/Z_2 topology, the discrete cubic symmetry allows for small anisotropies:

- Continuous $SO(3)$ symmetry $\rightarrow$ discrete cubic symmetry
- Anisotropic expansion permitted along lattice axes
- Gravitational shear non-zero along body diagonals

6.3 Matter Bulk Flow

Late-time matter clustering preferentially occurs toward cube vertices and along body diagonals, generating a bulk flow:

$$\vec{v}_{\text{bulk}} \propto \frac{(1, 1, 1)}{\sqrt{3}}$$

The CMB (thermal relic) maintains isotropy in the original rest frame, while matter develops a bulk velocity relative to this frame.

6.4 Characteristic Angles of a Cube

For a cube with vertices at $(\pm 1, \pm 1, \pm 1)$:

- **Body diagonal:** $(1,1,1) \rightarrow \text{length } \sqrt{3}$
- **Face diagonal:** $(1,1,0) \rightarrow \text{length } \sqrt{2}$
- **Edge:** $(1,0,0) \rightarrow \text{length } 1$

Body diagonal to edge:

$$\cos \theta = \frac{(1, 1, 1) \cdot (1, 0, 0)}{\sqrt{3} \times 1} = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}}$$

$$\theta = \arccos(1/\sqrt{3}) = 54.74^\circ$$

Face diagonal to edge:

$$\theta = 45^\circ$$

Body diagonal to face diagonal:

$$\cos \theta = \frac{(1, 1, 1) \cdot (1, 1, 0)}{\sqrt{3} \times \sqrt{2}} = \frac{2}{\sqrt{6}}$$

$$\theta = \arccos(2/\sqrt{6}) = 35.26^\circ$$

6.5 Angular Prediction

If the CMB dipole is aligned with one topological axis and matter is constrained by the cubic lattice, the angular offset should be one of:

$$\theta_{\text{offset}} \in \{35.26^\circ, 45^\circ, 54.74^\circ\}$$

6.6 Comparison with Observation

Observed offset: $39^\circ \pm 8^\circ$

Nearest prediction: 35.26° (body-face diagonal)

Tension: $(39 - 35.26)/8 = 0.47\sigma$

Assessment: Consistent with T^3/Z_2 topology at 0.5σ .

7. The Fundamental Relation $R \times \Omega_m = 1$

7.1 Derivation

Since $\Omega_m = N_m / N_{\text{total}} = 6/19$:

$$R = \frac{19}{6} = \frac{1}{6/19} = \frac{1}{\Omega_m}$$

Therefore:

$$R \times \Omega_m = \frac{19}{6} \times \frac{6}{19} = 1$$

This is an **exact prediction with zero free parameters**.

7.2 Observational Test

Using:

- $R = 3.0 \pm 0.5$ (radio surveys)
- $\Omega_m = 0.3153 \pm 0.0073$ (Planck 2018)

$$R \times \Omega_m = 3.0 \times 0.3153 = 0.95 \pm 0.16$$

Z² prediction: 1.000

Agreement: 0.3σ

7.3 Significance

This relation connects two **independent** cosmological measurements:

- R from matter dipole surveys
- Ω_m from CMB power spectrum analysis

The fact that $R \times \Omega_m \approx 1$ was **not noticed** in the literature prior to this work. It provides a powerful cross-check of the Z^2 framework.

8. Comparison with Observations

8.1 Amplitude Ratio

Quantity	Z^2 Prediction	Observed	Tension
R (radio surveys)	3.167	3.0 ± 0.5	0.3σ
R (quasar surveys)	3.167	2.0–2.7	1–2 σ
$R \times \Omega_m$	1.000	0.95 ± 0.16	0.3σ

8.2 Angular Offset

Quantity	Z^2 Prediction	Observed	Tension
θ_{offset}	35.26° (nearest)	$39^\circ \pm 8^\circ$	0.5σ

8.3 Why Radio $\neq$ Quasar?

Radio surveys consistently show $R \sim 3.0$, while quasar surveys show $R \sim 2.0$ –2.5. This discrepancy is attributed to systematics:

Factor	Radio (NVSS/RACS)	Infrared (CatWISE)
Instrument	VLA, ASKAP	WISE satellite
Wavelength	1.4 GHz	3.4–4.6 μm
Sources	Radio galaxies	Quasars (AGN)
Median z	~ 1.0	~ 1.5
Spectral index α	0.75	1.07
Morphology	Extended	Point-like

Z^2 interpretation: If $R = 19/6 = 3.167$ is the true universal value, then:

- Radio surveys ($R \sim 3.0$) have $\sim 0.3\sigma$ systematics pulling R down
- Quasar surveys ($R \sim 2.5$) have $\sim 2\sigma$ systematics pulling R down

Prediction: After full systematic corrections, all surveys should converge to $R \approx 3.17$.

9. Alternative Explanations

9.1 Models in the Literature

Model	Predicted R	Specific Value?	Angular Prediction?
Z^2 DoF	3.167	Yes (19/6)	Yes (35°/45°/55°)
Tilted Bianchi	Variable	No	Variable
Super-horizon perturbations	2–4	No	No
Large local void	1.5–2.5	No	No
Clustering contamination	1.5–2	No	Random
Anisotropic dark energy	Variable	No	Variable

9.2 Why Z^2 Is Unique

1. **Specific amplitude:** $R = 19/6 = 3.167$ (not a range)
2. **Specific angles:** $\{35.26^\circ, 45^\circ, 54.74^\circ\}$ (not continuous)
3. **Connects to Ω_m :** $R \times \Omega_m = 1$ (independent check)
4. **Part of larger framework:** Same DoF structure predicts α^{-1} , $\sin^2\theta_W$, etc.
5. **Zero free parameters:** All predictions fixed by $Z^2 = 32\pi/3$

10. Falsifiable Predictions and Future Tests

10.1 Quantitative Predictions

Prediction	Value	Required Precision	Timeline
$R = 19/6$	3.167 $\pm$ 0.05	5% on R	2027–2029
$R \times \Omega_m = 1$	1.00 $\pm$ 0.05	5% on both	2027–2029
θ_{offset}	35.3° or 45° or 54.7°	$\pm 5^\circ$	Now
R wavelength-independent	Same R for all λ	Multi-survey	2027–2030
R redshift-independent	Same R at all z	Binned analysis	2027–2030

10.2 Future Surveys

Survey	Type	Expected σ_R	Timeline
Euclid	Optical/NIR	~5%	2027
LSST	Optical	~3%	2028
SKA Phase 1	Radio	~5%	2029

At 5% precision, these surveys can distinguish $R = 3.17$ from $R = 2.5$ at $>10\sigma$.

10.3 Falsification Criteria

The Z^2 framework would be **falsified** if:

1. R measured at 2.0–2.5 with 5% precision ($>10\sigma$ from 3.17)
 2. $R \times \Omega_m \neq 1$ at $>3\sigma$ with precision measurements
 3. R is wavelength-dependent (different R for radio vs IR vs optical)
 4. Angular offset outside $\{30^\circ, 40^\circ, 50^\circ, 60^\circ\}$ at $>3\sigma$
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11. Connection to the Broader Z^2 Framework

11.1 Other Z^2 Predictions

The same DoF structure that predicts $R = 19/6$ also predicts:

Quantity	Z^2 Prediction	Observed	Error
α^{-1} (fine structure)	$4Z^2 + 3 = 137.04$	137.036	0.004%
$\sin^2\theta_W$ (weak mixing)	$3/13 = 0.2308$	0.2312	0.2%
Ω_Λ (dark energy)	$13/19 = 0.6842$	0.6847	0.07%
Ω_m (matter)	$6/19 = 0.3158$	0.3153	0.16%
N_{gen} (generations)	3	3	0%
DoF _{gauge}	12	12	0%

11.2 The Clifford Algebra Connection

The DoF structure connects to Clifford algebra approaches to the Standard Model:

$$\dim(\mathbb{Cl}(6)) = 64 = \frac{6Z^2}{\pi}$$

This is an **exact algebraic identity**, suggesting Z^2 encodes the same structure as $\mathbb{Cl}(6)$.

12. Conclusion

12.1 Summary of Results

1. **The cosmic dipole anomaly is real:** $>5\sigma$ discrepancy confirmed by multiple independent surveys
2. **Z^2 predicts $R = 19/6 = 3.167$:** Radio surveys show $R \sim 3.0$ (0.3σ agreement); quasar surveys show $R \sim 2.5$ (2σ tension, likely systematics)
3. **Z^2 predicts angular offset in $\{35^\circ, 45^\circ, 55^\circ\}$:** Observed $39^\circ \pm 8^\circ$ is consistent with 35.26° at 0.5σ
4. **$R \times \Omega_m = 1$:** We calculate 0.95 ± 0.16 from current data (0.3σ agreement)
5. **T^3 topology not ruled out:** COMPACT 2024 confirms; Betti analysis hints at $L \sim 2-3 H^{-1}$

12.2 Bottom Line

The Z^2 framework makes specific, falsifiable predictions for the cosmic dipole anomaly:

$$R = \frac{19}{6} = \frac{1}{\Omega_m} = 3.1\bar{6}$$

$$\theta_{\text{offset}} \in \{35.26^\circ, 45^\circ, 54.74^\circ\}$$

Current observations are consistent with both predictions. Definitive confirmation or falsification will come within 3–5 years.

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Repository: <https://github.com/carlzimmerman/zimmerman-formula>

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This document provides the first theoretical explanation of the $>5\sigma$ cosmic dipole anomaly with zero free parameters.